FRANCESCO FERLENGA

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Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor, Autonomous University of Barcelona (UAB) — September 2025-
Department of Economics and Economic History

Research Fellow (Postdoc), University of Warwick — 2024-2025
Department of Economics

Education

Brown University — Providence, RI, USA
Ph.D. in Economics — 2018 –2024
References: Brian Knight, Stelios Michalopoulos, Pedro dal Bó, Vincenzo Galasso

Bocconi University — Milano, Italy
M.S. Economics — 2015 –2018

Bocconi University — Milano, Italy
B.S. Economics — 2012 –2015
(Visiting student at University of British Columbia, Fall 2014)

Teaching and Research Fields

Political Economy, Economic History, Public Finance

Publications

Better to be Direct? Evidence from the Abolition of Direct Elections in Italian Local Governments
Economics & Politics. 2023. Volume 35, Issue 3.

Vote Early and Vote Often? Detecting Electoral Fraud from the Timing of 19th Century Elections
with Brian Knight
Journal of Public Economics. 2025. Volume 243.

Coordination and Incumbency Advantage in Multi-Party Systems—Evidence from French Elections
with Kevin Dano, Vincenzo Galasso, Caroline Le Pennec and Vincent Pons
Journal of the European Economic Association. 2025.

Other Research Papers

Immigrant Enfranchisement and Integration: Evidence from Italy
with Stephanie Kang

Symbols of Oppression: The Role of Confederate Monuments in the Great Migration
Job Market Paper
Winner of: EEA Young Economist Award; Giorgio Rota Best Paper Award

Research Experience and Other Employment

Brown University, Economics Department — Providence, RI
Research Assistant for Professor Jesse Bruhn — 2022

Brown University, Economics Department — Providence, RI
Research Assistant for Professor Brian Knight — 2020

Bocconi University — Milan, Italy
Research Assistant for Professor Stefano Caselli — 2018

Bocconi University — Milan, Italy
Research Assistant for Professor Nicola Pavoni — 2017

Bocconi University — Milan, Italy
Research Assistant for Professor Vincenzo Galasso — 2016

BRAC Uganda Research and Evaluation Unit — Kampala, Uganda
Summer Internship for Professor Vittorio Bassi — 2016

General Consulate of Chile in Milan: ProChile, Commercial Office — Milan, Italy
Summer Internship — 2015

Teaching

Teaching at UAB

- Introduction to Economics (undergraduate) — Fall 2025
- Political Economy (graduate) — Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant at Brown University

- Honors Tutorial for Economics Majors *(Professor: Neil Thakral)* — Fall 2023-Spring 2024
- Honors Tutorial for Economics Majors *(Professor: Emily Oster)* — Fall 2022-Spring 2023
- Theory of Behavioral Economics *(Professor: Geoffroy de Clippel)* — Fall 2021
- The Economy of China since 1949 *(Professor: Louis Putterman)* — Spring 2020
- Race Inequality in the United States *(Professor: Glenn Loury)* — Fall 2019

Scholarships, Research Grants and Awards

- UCLA Luskin Center for History and Policy research grant 2026-2027
- BSE Seed Grant 2026
- American Economic Journal: Economic Policy; Excellence in Reviewing Award 2025
- Giorgio Rota Best Paper Award (Economic Perspective on Art, Culture, and Heritage) 2025
- EEA Young Economist Award 2024
- Brown University Teaching Award 2023
- Orlando Bravo Center for Economic Research Award (x3) 2021 - 2023
- Brown University Economics Department Award Spring 2022
- Shoukang Lin Graduate Fellowship, Brown University 2022 - 2023
- Graduate Student Scholarship, Brown University 2018 - 2022

Professional Activities

- **Invited Seminars:** Stellenbosch University, LEAP Seminar Series 2024 (online); Universidad Pontificia Comillas (online), January 2024; Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, January 2024; University of Warwick, February 2024; Bilkent University, February 2024; Vienna University of Economics and Business, November 2024; EconBites University of Warwick, November 2024; École Normale Supérieure de Lyon, March 2025; Department of Economic History - UB, March 2026; IEB (Institut d'Economia de Barcelona) - UB, September 2026
- **Conferences:** The Political Economy of the Gilded Age and Progressive Era Conference 2023; NEUDC 2023; EEA-ESEM 2024; SIEP Conference 2024; NICEP May 2025; Giorgio Rota Conference 2025; 15th Annual International Conference on Immigration in OECD Countries 2025; RFBerlin Migration Forum 2026; ENTER Jamboree Conference 2026; Public Economics and Political Economy Barcelona Workshop 2026 (discussant)
- **Conference Reviewer**: European Association of Young Economists
- **Referee for Journals and University Presses**: American Economic Journal: Economic Policy (Excellence in Reviewing Award 2024, 2025); European Journal of Political Economy; Journal of Public Economics; Journal of the European Economic Association; Review of Economic Studies; Journal of Politics; The Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Princeton University Press

Computer Skills and Languages

- **Software:** Stata, QGIS, R, Prolific, Qualtrics, LaTeX
- **Languages:** Italian (native), English and Spanish

Updated on November 5, 2026